

Shopping & Consumer Life

42 words · Shopping & Consumer Life

NOUNS

purchase

something that has been bought

Keep your receipt in case you need to return this purchase.

refund

money that is given back to a customer, usually because they are returning goods

They gave me a refund when the shoes didn't fit.

discount

a reduction in the normal price of something

I got a twenty percent discount for signing up online.

checkout

the point in a shop where customers pay for what they're buying

There's no need to queue: you can pay at the self-service checkout.

impulse buy

something bought suddenly and without planning, often on a whim

That fondue set was a complete impulse buy. I've never even used it.

warranty

a manufacturer's written promise to repair or replace a faulty product within a set period

Send it back: it's still well within the warranty.

retailer

a business that sells goods directly to the public

Several big retailers have cut prices ahead of the Christmas rush.

buyer's remorse

a feeling of regret shortly after making a purchase

I had major buyer's remorse the second I got the sofa home.

receipt

a printed or digital record proving that something has been paid for

You can't get a refund without the receipt.

bargain

something bought for less than it is really worth

At that price, it's an absolute bargain.

queue

a line of people waiting to pay or be served

The queue for the fitting rooms stretched right across the shop.

sale

a period when goods in a shop are offered at reduced prices

I got this coat half price in the summer sale.

consumer

a person who buys goods or services for personal use

Consumers are paying closer attention to where their food comes from.

compensation

money or another benefit given to make up for a loss, delay, or inconvenience

The airline offered compensation for the cancelled flight.

store credit

a shop voucher given instead of a cash refund, valid only at that shop

Instead of my money back, all I got was store credit.

steal

something you buy for a very low price, much cheaper than it's worth

At that price, it's an absolute steal.

planned obsolescence

the deliberate design of products to fail or become outdated after a limited time, forcing customers to replace them

Critics blame planned obsolescence for phones that slow down right when a new model launches.

shrinkflation

the practice of reducing a product's size or quantity while keeping its price the same

Shrinkflation means the same box now holds noticeably fewer biscuits.

gimmick

a trick or unusual feature used to attract attention or boost sales, with little real value

The free gift is just a gimmick to get you through the door.

ADJECTIVES

second-hand

previously owned by someone else, not new

I bought this jacket second-hand; you'd never guess it wasn't new.

pushy

too forceful in trying to get someone to do or buy something

The assistant was so pushy that I ended up buying two of everything.

faulty

not working properly because of a defect

The charger was faulty straight out of the box.

VERBS

exchange

to take a purchased item back to a shop and swap it for something else

I exchanged the shirt for a bigger size.

return

to take a bought item back to the shop it came from, usually for a refund or exchange

You can return it within thirty days if you change your mind.

haggle

to negotiate over the price of something

You're expected to haggle a bit at the market, so don't just pay the first price.

PHRASAL VERBS

shop around

to compare prices from different sellers before deciding what to buy

It's always worth shopping around before you commit to anything this expensive.

COLLOCATIONS

window shopping

looking at goods displayed in shops without actually buying anything

We didn't buy a thing; it was just window shopping.

customer service

the help and support a company gives to people who buy from it

Their customer service was fantastic. They sorted it out in minutes.

hard sell

an aggressive attempt to persuade someone to buy something

The moment we walked in, we got the hard sell.

price tag

the label on an item showing what it costs, or the cost of something in general

The dress looked lovely until I saw the price tag.

price gouging

charging unfairly high prices for something, especially when customers have little choice

There were reports of price gouging on umbrellas during the storm.

value for money

worth what it costs, in terms of quality or usefulness

It's not cheap, but it's genuinely good value for money.

status symbol

a possession that signals a person's wealth or social standing

A corner office used to be the ultimate status symbol.

IDIOMS

mint condition

in a state as good as new, with no damage or wear

The watch is still in mint condition, box and all.

burn a hole in your pocket

(of money) to make someone feel a strong urge to spend it quickly

That bonus is burning a hole in my pocket already.

drive a hard bargain

to negotiate very effectively in your own favour

She drove a hard bargain and knocked another fifty pounds off.

flash your cash

to spend or display money in an obvious, showy way

He loves flashing his cash whenever a new gadget comes out.

get stung

to be cheated or charged far more than something is really worth

I got stung with a delivery charge that nearly doubled the price at checkout.

SET PHRASES

worth it

good enough to justify the money, time, or effort spent on it

It cost more than I planned, but it was worth it.

built to last

made to be durable and to function well over a long period

Appliances used to be built to last. This one's already given up after a year.

just looking

said to a shop assistant to mean you're browsing rather than ready to buy

I told the assistant I was just looking, and carried on round the shop.

MODERN SLANG

freebie

something given away free, often as a promotion

We got a couple of freebies thrown in with the order.